(Figure 5.17), she attributed the renovations at the Palace to the years following 'Ala' al-Din Husain *Jahan-suz*'s destructive path through the region of Ghazna and Zamindawar.[41]

Sourdel-Thomine systematically identified the following mid-twelfth-century changes there (Figures 5.14 and 5.15): additions of epigraphic and other decorative elements to the Palace's principal southern façade, which Schlumberger contrasted to the "nudity" of the other façades (Figure 5.16)[42]; a *mihrab* in the Mosque of the Forecourt (Figure 5.18), part of the long esplanade approaching the Palace from the south; renovations of all four façades of the Palace's large central court (Figures 5.14, 5.19); the stucco revetment, epigraphic program, and *mihrab* of the oratory of Hall I (Figures 5.20–5.22), north of the central court; the stucco imitating cut brickwork in Apartment II, northeast of the central court; and the molded stucco and incised geometric decoration in Building XX, a northeastern annex to the Palace. Sourdel-Thomine also attributed to Shansabani patronage a new decorative program in Residence XIII (Figure 5.23), the so-called "Palace of Racquets," close to Bust on its northeastern flank. Since very little other definitively datable evidence has been recovered elsewhere in this vicinity, ceramic and epigraphic finds – together with archaeological stratigraphy and references in historical texts – have been the principal clues for the aforementioned chronological sequence.[43]

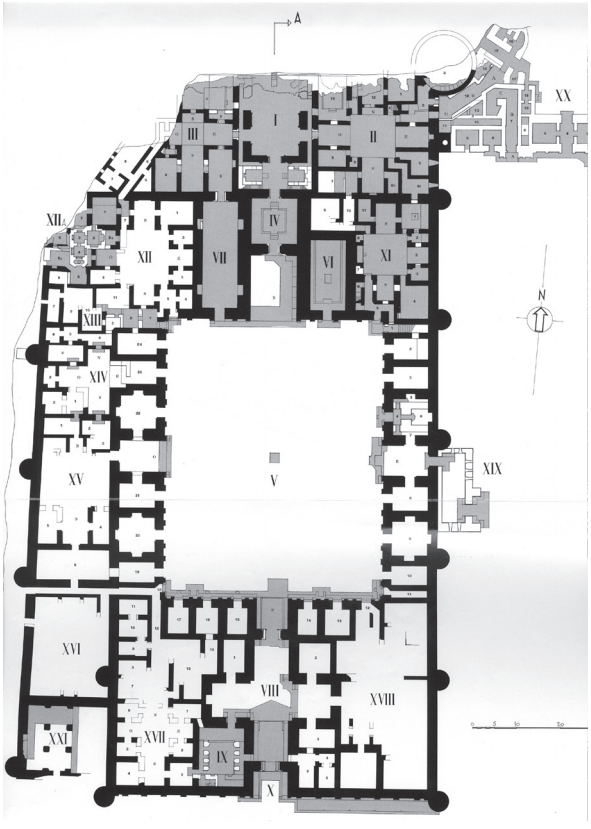


Figure 5.14 *Lashkari Bazar, Helmand Province, South Palace, plan of excavations. From Schlumberger 1978: pl. 4.*

With much less information at her disposal than we have now, Sourdel-Thomine applied the South Palace inscription's partial date of AH 55x/1156–1165 CE (Figure 5.17) to *all* later interventions within the complex. According to this chronology, the works would have taken place within the period immediately after 'Ala' al-Din Husain *Jahan-suz*'s mpaign of destruction at the site and throughout the Zabulistan–Zamindawar corridor in AH 545/1150 CE. To be sure, the partially surviving inscription could have referred to *some* work undertaken at the complex during this decade.